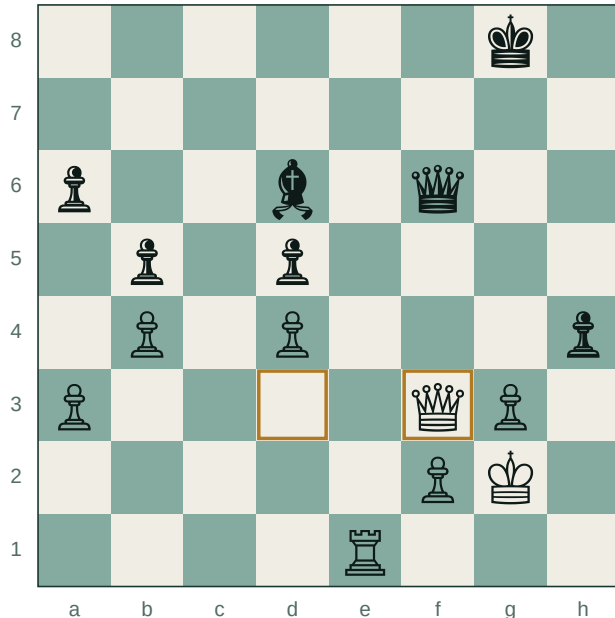


Deflection tactics: Black, move 38

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 38.Qf3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38...h3+ 39. Kxh3 Qxf3

38...h3+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **39.Kxh3**.

39...Qxf3 The queen captures the queen on f3.

At the end, nominal material is White 10 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +8:** the balance goes from -3 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g2. Geometrically undefended: rook on e1. Check for tactical protection.